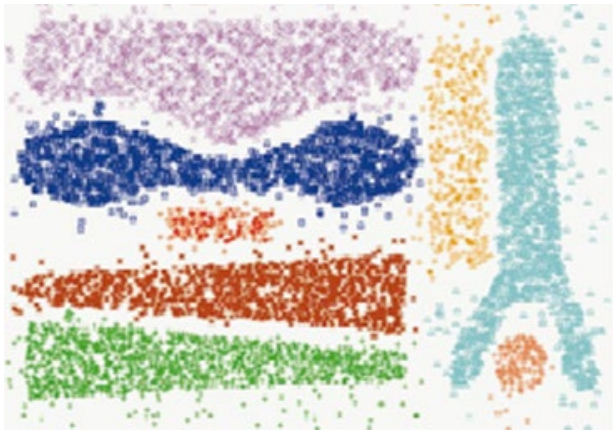


BIRCH: A Scalable and Flexible Clustering Method

- ❑ An integration of agglomerative clustering with other (flexible) clustering methods
- ❑ Low-level micro-clustering
 - ❑ Exploring CF-feature and BIRCH tree structure
 - ❑ Preserving the inherent clustering structure of the data
- ❑ Higher-level macro-clustering
 - ❑ Provide sufficient flexibility for integration with other clustering methods

BIRCH: Pros and Cons

- ❑ Strength: Good quality of clustering; linear scalability in large/stream databases; effective for incremental and dynamic clustering of incoming objects
- ❑ Weaknesses
 - ❑ Due to the fixed size of leaf nodes, clusters so formed may not be very natural
 - ❑ Clusters tend to be spherical given the radius and diameter measures



Images like this may give BIRCH a hard time